

Turkey

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** June 5, 1936 **Usage:** National and Civil

The star and crescent are both common symbols of the Islamic religion



The emblems are always placed slightly toward the hoist

One star point touches the invisible line that joins the two horns of the crescent moon

Asia



Following **Turkey's** defeat in the World War I, Mustafa Kemal Atatürk deposed the Sultan in 1922, and declared the country a republic in 1923.

Turkey's flag dates from 1844, although similar red flags were used as early as the 17th century within the Ottoman Empire. From 1920–1923, when Turkey became a republic, all the emblems of the Sultan were abolished and the flag became the main emblem.

THE CRESCENT AND STAR

Using the crescent and star emblems together is a relatively recent device, but the crescent on its own dates back to the Middle Ages. It is a symbol associated with Islam and also with Osman, the founder of the Ottoman Empire. The star first appeared on the flag in 1793. Initially it had eight points, but by

the early 19th century it usually had the five seen today. In 1936, the national flag and all the other flags used in Turkey today were fully defined and specified.

A PAN-ISLAMIC SYMBOL

The crescent and star has become an emblem of the pan-Islamic movement sponsored by Turkey in the late 19th century and these symbols are now widely used on the flags and national arms of Muslim countries.

Turkey does not have a coat of arms, but there are individual flags for the President and senior members of the Turkish navy. These also contain the traditional crescent and star.